

16. When did the Muslim League announce 'Direct Action'?

- (a) 22 June 1946 (b) 16 August 1946
(c) 22 October 1946 (d) 22 August 1946

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2025

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

17. When did Muslim League observe "Direct Action Day" ?

- (a) 14 August , 1946
(b) 15 August , 1947
(c) 16 August , 1946
(d) More than one of the above

70th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above questions.

Partition of India and Independence

*Clement R. Attlee was the Prime Minister of Britain when India got Independence from Britishers. He was the Prime Minister from the year 1945 to 1951 AD. Clement Attlee was from the Labour Party. On **20th February, 1947 AD**, Attlee in House of Commons declared that before **June, 1948 AD** we will free India and transfer the power of the Government in Indian hands. He said that the British Government is not responsible for India's partition. *Attlee made **Lord Mountbatten** the viceroy after replacing Wavell. Mountbatten came to India in **March 1947 AD**, and started the proceedings of transfer of power. He was given the task of the transfer of power with instructions to protect the integrity of India and take decisions as per the need of India so that Britain could depart from India with honour and with minimal damages.

*Mountbatten during the talks on the transfer of power reached on a conclusion that partition of India and formation of Pakistan is a must. He prepared a plan, keeping in mind the instructions by Attlee. The plan was prepared for the partition of India, this plan is known as the **Mountbatten Plan (3rd June, 1947 AD)**.

*As per the plan on July 1947 AD, **Indian Independence Act** was passed by the British Parliament in which two nations India and Pakistan were given dominion status and the deadline for the formation of Pakistan and India as two nations were fixed to 15th August, 1947 AD. ***Indian's Independence Bill** was presented by Attlee on **4th July, 1947 AD** in the House of Commons in British Parliament. House of Commons passed this Bill on **15th July, 1947 AD** and was passed by House of Lords the next day. The Bill got Royal Assent of his Majesty on 18th July, 1947 AD. *Between 24 March and 6 May 1947 AD, in

series of 133 interviews with Indian politicians Mountbatten reached on a conclusion that outline of Cabinet Mission had been impractical. So he prepared another substitute plan for this and termed it as "**Balkan Plan**". *Punjab Boundary Council and Bengal Boundary Council were formed by Mountbatten on **30th June, 1947 AD** to determine the division of land between India and Pakistan along with Punjab and Bengal. **Cyril Radcliffe** was the chairman of both the Councils. The councils was given the task to divide Punjab and Bengal on the basis of Muslim and Non-Muslim majority population. For this task, he had to take in consideration of various other elements too. Each council had four members two from Congress and two from the Muslim League. Gandhiji, in his first meeting with Mountbatten on 31st March 1947 AD, suggested that the control of the Interim Government be handed completely to **Md. Ali Jinnah** who was the leader of the Muslim League so that these communal riots in India be stopped, but Congress leaders and Congress Working Committee didn't support this proposal of Gandhi.

*On partition, Gandhiji said, "Congress will have to move over my dead body if it will divide India". I will never be a supporter of partition till my last breath. If I were to choose I will never let Congress be ready for partition. ***J. B. Kriplani** was the Congress President when Congress General Committee in Delhi accepted the proposal of partition of India on **14-15 June, 1947 AD**. This proposal was presented by Govind Vallabh Pant and Maulana Abul Kalam Azad seconded this proposal. *On November 1947, J.B. Kriplani resigned from Congress and Dr. Rajendra Prasad became the congress President. In Jaipur Session of Congress (1948 AD), **Pattabhi Sitaramayya** became the next Congress President. In the year 1950 AD, at Nasik session of Congress, **Purushottam Das Tandon** became the new Congress President. Nehru was President of Congress from 1951 to 1954 AD. ***Khan Abdul Gaffar Khan** (Frontier Gandhi) voted against the proposal for India's partition at the meeting of All India Congress Working Committee on 14/15 June 1947 AD (mention of both dates are found). ***Dr. Saifuddin Kitchlew** upon the passing of this proposal said that today Nationalism surrendered to Communalism. He was President of the Congress Committee of Punjab Province and was against the partition. After Independence, he separated himself from Congress and later joined the Communist Party of India. *On 14/15 August 1947 AD, at midnight Constituent Assembly took charge as an Interim Parliament. The meeting of Constituent Assembly was held at the midnight of 14 August. *On this occasion of Independence, Jawahar Lal Nehru gave a very influential speech in the Assembly. On 14th August 1947 AD, in the midnight '**Jan-Gan-Man**' and '**Sare-Jahan-Se Achha**' song was sung by **Sucheta Kriplani**. In the Assembly Jawahar Lal Nehru was appointed as Prime Minister of India by the then Governor General **Lord Mountbatten**. Lord

Mountbatten was the **First Governor General of Independent India** (1947-48 AD) whereas **C. Rajagopalachari** was the **First Indian Governor-General of Independent India (1948-50 AD)**. ***C. Rajagopalachari** during the years 1948-50 AD was the first and last Indian Governor-General of Independent India. He stayed on this post until 26th January, 1950 AD. He was the Chief Minister of Madras from year 1952 to 1954 AD. **B.R. Ambedkar** was the **first Law Minister** of free India. On the recommendation of Gandhiji during Independence B.R. Ambedkar was given this position. He worked as the President of the **Drafting Committee**. *Indian national leaders wanted to make 26th January a memorable day (26 January 1930 Independence day celebration), that is why our constitution completely came into force on **26th January 1950 AD** since it was fully prepared on 26 November, 1949 AD. 26 January was declared as **'Republic Day'**. *R. Coupland said, "Indian nationalism is child of English rule". But he forgot that for him Indian nationalism was an undesirable child which was denied milk in the childhood, and after that, efforts were made to choke it till death. * On the unification of India by British rule K.M. Pannikar said, "The Greatest Achievement of British Rule is the Unity of India".

1. Which one of the following parties was in power in the U.K. when India got Independence?

- (a) Conservative Party (b) Labour Party
(c) Liberal Party (d) Socialist Party

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

Ans. (b)

During the independence of India, Clement Richard Attlee from Labour party was the Prime Minister of U.K. He was the Prime Minister of U.K. from 1945 to 1951 AD.

2. Who was the Prime Minister of England when India attained independence?

- (a) Winston Churchill (b) Clement Attlee
(c) Harold Mc Millan (d) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

3. The British Government decided and declared to leave India by June, 1948 in :

- (a) 1946 (b) February, 1947
(c) April, 1947 (d) June, 1947

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (b)

Prime Minister of Britain Attlee declared in the House of Commons on February, 20, 1947 AD that British will leave India before June, 1948 AD, after transferring power to liable people. Attlee appointed Lord Mountbatten as the Viceroy of India in place of Wavell. Mountbatten initiated the efforts of power transfer in March, 1947 AD.

4. Lord Mountbatten came to India as a Viceroy along with specific instruction to –

- (a) Balkanize the Indian sub-continent
(b) Keep India United if possible
(c) Accept Jinnah's demand for Pakistan
(d) Persuade the Congress to accept partition

I.A.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (b)

The Prime Minister of the United Kingdom, Clement Attlee announced on 20th February, 1947 AD in the House of Commons that he wish to transfer powers to India but also said that if in time the decision related to the constitution is not made British Empire has the power to transfer Government to any of them. Thus, to effect the transfer of power, Attlee decided to send Lord Mountbatten as Viceroy to India. Lord Mountbatten armed with vast powers became India's Viceroy on 24 March, 1947 AD. Mountbatten became Viceroy of India with a mandate to oversee the British withdrawal. Lord Mountbatten came to India as Viceroy of India along with specific instructions to keep India United if possible however he was authorized to make decisions according to favourable Indian circumstances and minimum British loss. Mountbatten concluded that a United India was an unachievable goal and resigned himself to a plan for partition, creating the independent nations of India and Pakistan.

5. On February 20, 1947, Prime Minister Attlee announced the British Government's decision to withdraw from India latest by

- (a) June 1948
(b) August 1947
(c) January 1948
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

On 20 February, 1947 AD British Prime Minister Clement Attlee, announced in the House of Commons that the British would leave India by 30 June, 1948. AD Hence option (a) is correct.

6. Which plan became the platform of Indian Independence?

- (a) Cripps Plan (b) Wavell Plan
(c) Mountbatten Plan (d) None of the above

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (c)

Lord Mountbatten came to India in March, 1947 AD with the purpose to give complete independence to India. He decided 15 August, 1947 AD as the date for power transfer. He made a plan of partition of India under instructions of Attlee which was considered as Mountbatten Plan.

7. The Mountbatten Plan became the basis for :

- (a) Continuity of British Rule.
- (b) Transfer of power.
- (c) Partition of the country.
- (d) Solution of communal problems.

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b&c)

See the explanation of the above question.

8. The British Parliament passed the Indian Independence Act in –

- (a) January, 1947
- (b) July, 1947
- (c) August, 1947
- (d) August, 1946

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

Uttarakhand U.D.A./ L.D.A. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (b)

As per the Mountbatten Plan (June 3, 1947 AD), British Parliament passed the Indian Independence Act on July, 1947 AD. The bill received Royal Assent of his majesty on 18 July, 1947 AD. In this Act, India and Pakistan were decided as two dominion States with effect from 15 August, 1947 AD.

9. The Indian Independence Act, 1947 came into force on –

- (a) July 4, 1947
- (b) July 10, 1947
- (c) July 18, 1947
- (d) August 14, 1947

U.P.R.O./ A.R.O. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

10. The formula for transfer of sovereignty to India in 1947 was known as –

- (a) Durand Plan
- (b) Morley-Minto Reforms
- (c) Mountbatten Plan
- (d) Wavell Plan

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

11. "Mountbatten Plan" regarding the partition of India was officially declared on :

- (a) June 04, 1947
- (b) June 10, 1947
- (c) July 03, 1947
- (d) June 03, 1947

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (d)

Mountbatten Plan regarding the partition of India was officially declared on June 3, 1947 AD. The British Government accorded formal approval to the Mountbatten Plan by enacting the Indian Independence Act.

12. Assertion (A) : Britain made India free in 1947.

Reason (R) : Britain had become weak during the second World War.

In the context of the above two statements, which of the following is/are correct?

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not a correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

U.P. P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

U.P. Lower Sub.(Spl.) (Pre) 2003

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (a)

Assertion (A) and Reason (R) both are correct and (R) is correct explanation of (A). Britishers were weak after the Second World War and after evaluating the National Movement of India it is clear that people of various castes, religions, organisations and parties contributed to the independence.

13. Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other labeled as Reason (R).

Assertion (A) : The British sovereignty continued to exist in free India.

Reason (R) : The British sovereign appointed the last Governor-General of free India.

In the context of the above two statements, which one of the following is correct?

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

I.A.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

The Indian Independence Act was presented in the House of Commons in British Parliament on July 4, 1947 AD. It received royal assent on July 18, 1947 AD. According to its provisions, the British Government would not continue any control over any dominion from 15 August, 1947 AD. The second statement is correct as British Sovereign appointed the last Governor-General of free India. Thus, Assertion (A) is false, but Reason (R) is true.

14. The Indian Independence Bill received the Royal Assent on –

- (a) July 18th, 1947
- (b) July 19th, 1947
- (c) July 20th, 1947
- (d) July 21st, 1947

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (a)

The Indian Independence Act of 1947 was an implementation of the Mountbatten Plan. The Indian Independence Act was presented in the House of commons of British Parliament on July 4, 1947 AD by the then Prime Minister of the United Kingdom, Clement Attlee. The Indian Independence Act was passed by the House of Commons on July 15, 1947 AD and next day by the House of Lords. Finally, it received royal assent on July 18, 1947 AD.

15. The Balkan Plan for fragmentation of India was the brain child of –

- (a) W. Churchill
- (b) M.A. Jinnah
- (c) Lord Mountbatten
- (d) V.P. Menon

I.A.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (c)

After arriving in India to negotiate terms for an Independent India, Mountbatten soon concluded that transfer of power to one central representative constituency assembly for India would be impossible to achieve as neither the India National Congress nor the Muslim League could agree to the terms, and he accordingly came up with 'Plan Balkan', separate dominion for Pakistan, the Princely States and the rest of British India with certain key areas of administration run by Central Government.

16. The Indian National Congress agreed in 1947 to the partition of the country mainly because –

- (a) The principle of Two-Nation Theory was then acceptable to them.
- (b) It was imposed by the British Government and the Congress was helpless in this regard.
- (c) They wanted to avoid large-scale communal riots.
- (d) India would have otherwise lost the opportunity to attain freedom.

I.A.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (c)

Attlee announced the appointment of Lord Mountbatten as Viceroy replacing Lord Wavell. Lord Mountbatten, the last British Governor-General and Viceroy arrived in India in March, 1947 AD and immediately began to take measures for the transfer of power. The prevailing communal violence in the country led Mountbatten to announce the partition plan on 3rd June, 1947 AD. The Congress leaders too had come to the conclusion that partition was the only choice to check the widespread communal violence and bloodshed that was ravaging the country. The plan provided for the immediate transfer of power on the basis of the grant of Dominion Status. The Indian National Congress agreed to the partition of the Country mainly because they wanted to avoid large-scale communal riots.

17. Assertion (A) : The Indian National Congress accepted the Mountbatten plan.

Reason (R) : It believed in Two-Nation Theory.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (c)

Assertion (A) is correct, but reason (R) is wrong as though INC accepted Mountbatten plan, but they never accepted 'Two Nation Theory.' The reason behind their acceptance of the Mountbatten Plan was to avoid communal riots in the country.

18. As an alternative to the partition of India, Gandhiji suggested to Mountbatten that he –

- (a) Postpone granting of independence.
- (b) Invite Jinnah to form the Government.
- (c) Invite Nehru and Jinnah to form the Government together.
- (d) Invite the army to take over for some time.

I.A.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

The first meeting between Gandhiji and Mountbatten took place on 31st March, 1947 AD. As an alternative to the partition of India, Gandhiji suggested to Mountbatten that the best course would be to ask Jinnah to take over as Prime Minister of Interim Government and run the affairs of the Country but this suggestion of Gandhiji was not acceptable to Congress Leaders and Congress Working Committee. He told his attendants: "Today I find myself all alone. Even Sardar and Jawaharlal think that he was wrong, and peace was sure to return if the partition was agreed upon. Nevertheless, I must speak as I feel ... we may not feel the full impact immediately, but, I can see clearly that the future of independence gained at this price is going to be dark. Should the evil I apprehend overtake India ... let posterity know what agony this old soul went through, thinking of it.... Let it not be said that Gandhi was party to Indian vivisection."

19. The Radcliffe Committee was appointed to –

- (a) Solve the problem of minorities in India.
- (b) Give effect to the Independence Bill.
- (c) Demarcate the boundaries between India and Pakistan.
- (d) Enquire into the riots in East Bengal.

I.A.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (c)

Viceroy of British India, Lord Mountbatten formed two commissions namely Punjab Border Commission and Bengal Border Commission to decide the borderline between India and Pakistan on June 30, 1947 AD. Cyril Radcliffe was appointed as President of both the Commissions. Those Commissions had to demarcate borders by Muslims and Non-Muslims population. They had to consider other factors too. There were four members in each Commission of which two were from Indian National Congress and two from the Muslim League.

20. Who headed the Boundary Commission appointed in 1947 in the context of India's partition?

- (a) Mountbatten (b) Radcliffe
(c) James Bolt (d) Richardson

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

21. Who among the following headed the two Boundary Commissions set up to delineate the international frontiers between India and Pakistan in 1947?

- (a) Cyril Radcliffe
(b) A.P. Moon
(c) A.V. Alexander
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

Bengal and Punjab boundary commissions were established in 1947 AD under chairmanship of British lawyer Cyril Radcliffe for the purpose of determining new border between India and Pakistan following independence from British rule. The Radcliffe line became the border between India and Pakistan when the Award was published on 17 August 1947, two days after partition.

22. The last opportunity to avoid the partition of India was lost with the rejection of:

- (a) Cripps Mission
(b) Rajagopalachari Formula
(c) Cabinet Mission
(d) Wavell Plan

I.A.S. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (c)

The Cabinet Mission of India of 1946 AD had come up with a plan on 16 May, 1946 AD which intended to create a United India with independent Muslim and Hindu majority provinces in which demand of Pakistan raised by Muslim League was rejected, but Muslim League approved the plan on 6th June, 1946 AD. On

July 29, it rejected the plan and called the Muslims to resort to "Direct Action" to achieve the land of their dream "Pakistan." August 16, 1946 AD was fixed as "Direct Action Day." As a result, the last opportunity to avoid the partition of India was lost with the rejection of Cabinet Mission.

23. Who among the following was the Chairman of the Congress Session of Delhi wherein resolution of divided India was passed on June 15, 1947?

- (a) Rajendra Prasad (b) Vallabhbhai Patel
(c) Acharya J.B. Kriplani (d) Jawaharlal Nehru

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2007

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

When All India Congress Working Committee accepted the proposal of divided India in Delhi on 14-15 June, 1947 AD (mention of both dates are found), J.B. Kriplani was the President of Indian National Congress. This proposal was presented by Gobind Vallabh Pant and supported by Maulana Azad, Sardar Patel and Jawaharlal Nehru. In November, 1947 AD J.B. Kriplani resigned from Congress Chairmanship. After that, Dr. Rajendra Prasad became interim Chairman of Congress. Pattabhi Sitaramayya became next President of Congress in Jaipur Session in 1948 AD. Then P.D. Tandon became new President of Congress in Nasik Session in 1950 AD.

24. Who presided over the Delhi Session of Indian National Congress in 1947?

- (a) J. B. Kriplani (b) Rajendra Prasad
(c) Abul Kalam Azad (d) Jawaharlal Nehru

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

25. Who among the following had seconded the resolution on the partition in the meeting of All India Congress Committee held in New Delhi in 1947?

- (a) Govind Ballabh Pant (b) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
(c) J.B. Kriplani (d) Abul Kalam Azad

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (d)

A meeting was organized on 14-15 June, 1947 AD by All India Congress to approve the plan for the partition of India of 3rd June, 1947 AD. Gobind Vallabh Pant introduced the proposal of the partition of India and Maulana Abul Kalam Azad seconded this proposal.

26. Who of the following took the passing of a resolution on the partition in the meeting of the Congress Committee(1947) as a "Surrender of Nationalism in favour of Communalism."

- (a) Dr. Kitchlew (b) Purushottam Das Tandon
(c) Jawaharlal Nehru (d) G.B. Pant

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (a)

Dr. Kitchlew then the president of Punjab Regional Congress Committee was in strong opposition to partition. He termed the partition of India as "Surrender of the nationalism in favour of Communalism." He isolated himself from Congress and associated himself with the Communist Party of India.

27. In the meeting of All India Committee on June 14-15, 1947; who among voted against the partition of India?

- (a) Abul Kalam Azad (b) Khan Abdul Gaffar Khan
(c) Sardar Patel (d) Gobind Vallabh Pant

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (b)

In the Delhi Session of I.N.C. on June 14-15, 1947 AD, Khan Abdul Gaffar Khan (Seemant Gandhi) voted against the partition of India.

28. Which of the following assumed sovereign power at midnight of 14/15 August, 1947 provisionally?

- (a) Central Legislative Assembly
(b) Constituent Assembly
(c) Interim Government
(d) Chamber of Princes

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (b)

The Constituent Assembly, as the Provisional Parliament, assumed Sovereign power at midnight on August 14-15, 1947 AD. A special session of the Constituent Assembly was held in New Delhi on 14-15 August, 1947 AD. Jawaharlal Nehru delivered a speech as India's first Prime Minister in the Constituent Assembly in New Delhi at midnight on August 14-15, 1947 AD. This historic speech was full of ideas and embellishments to inspire a Nation, about to make a new beginning.

29. Who sang 'Hindustan Hamara' of Iqbal and 'Jan-gan-man' in the Central Assembly at midnight of 14/15 August, 1947?

- (a) Rameshwari Nehru (b) Meera Ben
(c) Sucheta Kriplani (d) M.S. Subbulakshmi

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (c)

In the Central Assembly at the midnight of August 14, 1947, Sucheta Kriplani sang "Jan-Gan-Man" and "Sare Jahan Se Achha Hindustan Hamara" written by Iqbal.

30. Who appointed the first Prime Minister of India?

- (a) Governor-General (b) British Emperor
(c) Mahatma Gandhi (d) Viceroy

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (a)

Governor-General of British India Lord Mountbatten appointed Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru as the first Prime Minister of India.

31. Who was the first Governor-General of Independent India?

- (a) C. Rajagopalachari (b) Warren Hastings
(c) Lord Dalhousie (d) Lord Mountbatten

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (d)

Lord Mountbatten (1947-48 AD) was the first Governor-General of Independent India while C. Rajagopalachari (1948-50 AD) was the first Indian Governor-General of Independent India.

32. Who among the following was the first Governor-General of Independent India?

- (a) Lord Mountbatten (b) Sir Stafford Cripps
(c) C. Rajagopalachari (d) Dr. Rajendra Prasad

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

33. Who was the last Governor-General of Independent India?

- (a) C. Rajagopalachari (b) Rajendra Prasad
(c) Lord Mountbatten (d) Lord Canning

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2004

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (a)

C. Rajagopalachari (1948-50 AD) was the last Governor-General of Independent India. He was Chief Minister of Madras (1952-54 AD). In 1959 AD, he left Congress due to some differences and formed a new party titled 'Swatantra Party.'

34. The first Indian to hold office as Governor-General of independent India was –

- (a) Rajagopalachari (b) Surinder Nath
(c) Dr. Rajendra Prasad (d) B. R. Ambedkar

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

35. The first and last Indian Governor-General of India was –

- (a) R.M. Gopala (b) Dr. S. Radhakrishnan
(c) C. Rajagopalachari (d) Ramanuja Acharya

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2007

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2006

Ans.(c)

See the explanation of the above question.

36. Last Viceroy of India was -

- (a) Lord Wavell (b) Lord Mountbatten
(c) Lord Linlithgow (d) Achinlake

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (b)

Lord Mountbatten (1947-48 AD) was the last British Viceroy and the Governor-General of India. He took charge on 24 March, 1947 AD and presented the plan of India's Partition on June 3, 1947 AD.

37. Who among the following was the first Law Minister of India?

- (a) M. C. Sitalwad (b) Dr. B.R. Ambedkar
(c) Kailash Nath Katju (d) Rafi Ahmad Kidwai

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (b)

Dr. B. R. Ambedkar was the first Law Minister of Independent India. He became the Law Minister on the recommendation of Mahatma Gandhi. He worked as the President of the Drafting Committee of the Constitution.

38. Which one of the following is the correct sequence of persons who occupied the office of the President of India right from the beginning?

- (a) C. Rajagopalachari, Rajendra Prasad, Zakir Hussain, V. V. Giri
(b) Rajendra Prasad, S. Radhakrishnan, V. V. Giri, Zakir Hussain
(c) C. Rajagopalachari, Rajendra Prasad, S. Radhakrishnan, Fakhruddin Ali Ahmad
(d) Rajendra Prasad, S. Radhakrishnan, Zakir Hussain, V. V. Giri

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (d)

Dr. Rajendra Prasad was the first President of India (1950-1962 AD), the second was Sarvapalli Radhakrishnan (1962-1967 AD), third was Zakir Hussain (1967-1969 AD), and V. V. Giri was the fourth President of India (1969-1974 AD).

39. Who represented the Indian National Congress in the Partition Council headed by Lord Mountbatten?

1. Abul Kalam Azad
2. Jawaharlal Nehru
3. Sardar Patel
4. Rajendra Prasad

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

Code :

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 3 and 4 (d) 1 and 4

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (b)

Jawaharlal Nehru and Sardar Patel represented Indian National Congress in the Partition Council headed by Lord Mountbatten. Lord Mountbatten presented his plan on June 3, 1947 AD.

40. Mountbatten Plan (June 1947) provided for a referendum in which of the following province(s)?

- (a) Sindh
(b) Baluchistan
(c) North-West Frontier Province
(d) All of these

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

The important points of the Mountbatten Plan (3 June, 1947 AD) were –
Punjab and Bengal legislative assemblies would meet in two groups, Hindus and Muslims, to vote for partition. If a simple majority of either group voted for partition, then these provinces would be partitioned.
Sindh would take its own decision.
Referendum in NWFP, Sindh, Baluchistan and Sylhet district of Assam would decide the fate of these areas.
Since the congress had conceded a unified India, all their other points would be met-
(i) Independence for princely states ruled out, they would either join India or Pakistan.
(ii) Independence for Bengal ruled out.
(iii) Accession of Hyderabad to Pakistan ruled out (Mountbatten supported the congress on this).

41. The President of Indian National Congress at the time of partition of India was –

- (a) C. Rajagopalachari
(b) J.B. Kriplani
(c) Jawaharlal Nehru
(d) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad

I.A.S. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (b)

During the partition of India, the Congress President was J. B. Kriplani, who was Congress President from 23rd November, 1946 AD to November, 1947 AD. He became President of I.N.C. in Meerut Session, 1946 AD. He resigned from his post in November, 1947 AD. After his resignation Dr. Rajendra Prasad become the president.

42. Who among the following was the President of the India National Congress on 15th August, 1947?

- (a) Rajendra Prasad (b) Jawaharlal Nehru
(c) J.B. Kriplani (d) Sardar Patel

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

43. Who presided over the 1946 Session of the Indian National Congress held at Meerut?

- (a) J.B. Kriplani
(b) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
(c) Dr. Rajendra Prasad
(d) B. Pattabhi Sitaramayya

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Pre) 2010

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

44. Who was the Congress President at the time of transfer of power in 1947 to India by the British?

- (a) Jawaharlal Nehru (b) Rajendra Prasad
(c) Abul Kalam Azad (d) J.B. Kriplani

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

45. In August 1947, who of the following leaders did not participate anywhere in Independence Day celebrations?

- (a) Jawaharlal Lal Nehru (b) Mahatma Gandhi
(c) Vallabh Bhai Patel (d) Rajendra Prasad

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (b)

Mahatma Gandhi did not participate anywhere in Independence Day celebrations on 15 August, 1947 AD. He was saddened by the partition of the country. He spent the day fasting and in prayer.

46. January 26, 1950 was chosen for the enforcement of the Constitution because:

- (a) This was an auspicious day.
(b) 'Quit India Movement' was begun on this date in 1942.
(c) Congress had celebrated 26 January, 1930 as the first Independence Day.
(d) None of the above.

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

In the year 1929 AD, at the annual session of Congress held at Lahore, 'Purna Swaraj' or Complete Independence was accepted as the goal of the Congress. On the banks of the river Ravi, at midnight on 31st December, 1929 AD, the tricolour flag of Indian Independence was unfurled amidst cheer and jubilation. 26th January, 1930 AD was marked as the first Independence Day, which was to be so celebrated every year. To commemorate this historic day, it was decided to enforce the Constitution on 26th January, 1950 AD.

47. "Indian Nationalism was the child of the British Rule." Who made this statement?

- (a) Bipin Chandra (b) R. Coupland
(c) R.C. Majumdar (d) P.E. Roberts

U.P. P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (b)

R. Coupland wrote that – "Indian Nationalism was the child of British Rule." But he forgot to add that Indian Nationalism was an involuntary child to whom they denied to feed and tried to throttle.

48. Who among the following said that "the most notable achievement of the British Rule was the unification of India"?

- (a) K.M. Panikkar (b) M.N. Srinivas
(c) Rajni Kothari (d) Yogendra Singh

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

Ans. (a)

K. M. Panikkar stated that "the most important achievement of British Rule was the unification of entire Indian sub-continent.

49. The British Monarch at the time of Indian Independence was

- (a) George V (b) George VI
(c) King Edward VII (d) None of these

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

George VI was the British monarch at the time of Indian independence. He was the king of the United Kingdom from 1936 AD until his death in 1952 AD.

50. How many principalities were merged in the 'Saurashtra Sangh' on 15th February, 1948?

- (a) 220 (b) 221
(c) 222 (d) 223

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

On 15th February, 1948 AD after the Independence of India Saurashtra Sangh was formed by merging 222 principalities of princely states. (217 of Kathiawar Agency and 5 of others).